9 LIVES

- 11 years
- 3-4 players
- 30 min



COMPONENTS

- A 36 Cards (1-9 in 4 suits)
- B 4 Cat Tokens
- C 4 Score Track Cubes
- D 4 Trick Tracking Cubes
- E 1 Score Track
- F 1 Start Player Token
- G 1 Prediction Rug
- H 4 Player Reference Tokens

OBJECTIVE

Each round you'll predict how many tricks you can win, but be careful, every victory adds another card back into your hand! Can you outwit the other players before your nine lives run out?

CREDITS

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Special Thanks: Renee Hammer

SETUP

1. Place the prediction rug and score track so all players can see them.
2. Give each player a cat token and matching player reference token.
3. Place each player's trick tracking cube below the rug and their score track cube on the 0 space of the score track.
4. Give the start player token to a random player.

In a 3-player game, remove the fish suit (Blue) cards. Shuffle the cards and deal 9 to each player.

PREDICT

Beginning with the start player and proceeding clockwise, each player predicts how many tricks they will win by placing their cat token horizontally next to a number or vertically next to two numbers on the bidding rug.

You may place your cat token on either side of the numbers on the rug. Once a cat occupies one side of a number no other cat can be placed next to that number on that side. No player can bid zero!





The yellow player predicts they will win 1 or 5 tricks. The blue player predicts they will win 2, 3, 6, or 7 tricks. The brown player predicts they will win 3, 4, 7, or 8 tricks. The red player may choose the 1/5, 2/6 or 4/8 space.

TRICKS



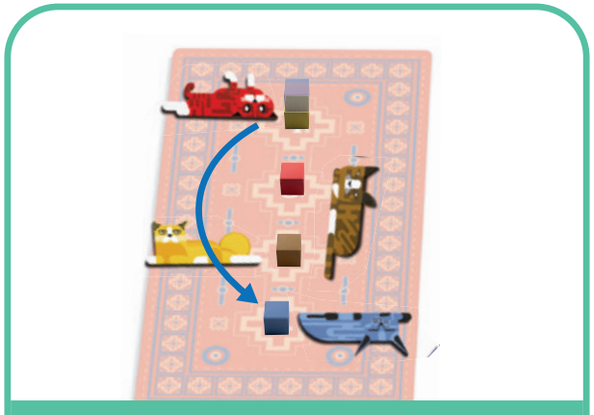
The start player plays a card faceup to the center of the table. The suit of this card is the “led-suit”. In clockwise order the other players must similarly play a card. They must play a card of the led-suit if they have one, otherwise they can play any card.



If any paw-suit (Purple) card is played, then the player who plays the highest paw-suit wins the trick. Otherwise, the highest led-suit card wins the trick.



The player who wins the trick takes one card from the trick, other than the card they played, and adds it to their hand. Then discards the other cards.



The winner advances their trick tracking cube one space on the prediction rug. If their cube was on the 4 spot, it wraps around to the 1 spot, indicating they have won 5 tricks.



The winner of the trick starts the next trick. The round ends when a player has no more cards at the end of a trick.

SCORE

If your cat is next to a single number space, and you won the number of tricks shown on that space, score **4 points**.

If your cat is next to two spaces, and you won the number of tricks shown on either of those spaces, score **2 points.**

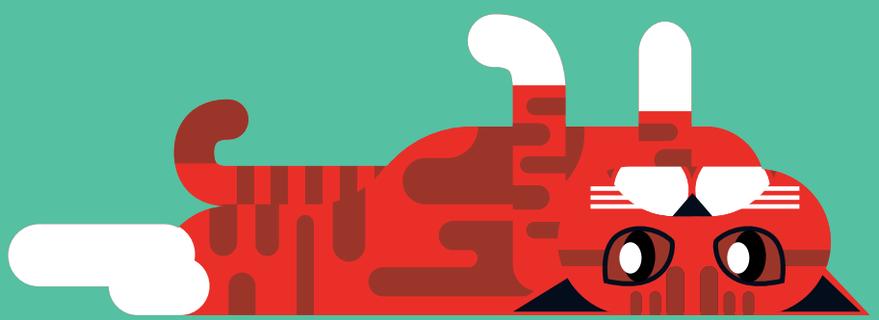
Otherwise, lose **1 point** for every space between your trick tracking cube and your cat token. Remember the betting track wraps from 4 to 5. Your score cannot be reduced below zero.

PLAY 4 ROUNDS

Pass the start player token clockwise.

Repeat the Deal, Predict, Tricks, and Score steps three more times or until a player reaches 9 or more points.

Highest score wins. If tied all tied players win.



SCORING EXAMPLE:



Tricks won	**5**	**2**	**4**	**1**
Points	**4**	**2**	**-2**	**-3**